

Saudi Commercial Pilot Licence (CPL)

GACAR Part 61 — going professional



Indicative study aid — not an official GACA document. Every age, hour, validity period and requirement must be verified against the current GACAR and confirmed with GACA before you rely on it. These points are condensed from the Fly GACA guide named below.

ELIGIBILITY

- Hold a PPL, or train through an integrated course toward the CPL.
- ICAO English Level 4 or higher.

MEDICAL

- A Class 1 aero-medical certificate is required for commercial privileges.
- The jump from Class 2 to Class 1 adds a fuller battery of tests — plan early.

FLIGHT TIME

- Integrated programme: 200 h total flight time.
- Modular path: 250 h total flight time, building on the PPL.
- Includes dedicated night and instrument time.

THEORY & SKILLS TEST

- A wider set of theoretical-knowledge subjects than the PPL.
- A CPL practical skills test flown to commercial standards.

RATINGS & CADETSHIPS

- Most cadets add multi-engine and instrument ratings in the same training block.
- Saudi airline cadetships (Saudia, flynas, flyadeal, Riyadh Air) expect both before line training.

PRIVILEGES

- Act as a pilot for hire and reward.
- Next steps: a type rating, the ATPL, or an instructor rating.

Condensed from the full Fly GACA guide — <https://flygaca-firebase.web.app/guides/saudi-cpl-requirements.html>. Fly GACA is an independent educational reference and is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or connected to the General Authority of Civil Aviation (GACA). The authoritative source for any regulation is always GACA — gaca.gov.sa.